centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

ANAPHYLAXIS ACTION PLAN

You (or your child) are at risk of anaphylaxis, a severe allergic reaction that can be life-threatening. Here are recommendations for recognizing and managing an anaphylactic reaction.

HOW TO RECOGNIZE AN ANAPHYLACTIC REACTION?

Early detection of symptoms and immediate treatment could save a life.

- **SKIN**: Hives, redness, itching, swelling (face, lips, tongue).
- **BREATHING**: Coughing, wheezing, shortness of breath, throat tightness, hoarse voice, difficulty swallowing, nasal congestion, or hay fever-like symptoms (runny or itchy nose, watery eyes, sneezing).
- **DIGESTION**: Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal pain.
- **CIRCULATION**: Pale or bluish skin, weak pulse, dizziness, loss of consciousness.
- **OTHER**: Anxiety, feeling of distress.

If you suddenly develop **any combination of TWO (2) categories of symptoms** OR experience severe breathing difficulty, severe malaise or loss of consciousness, use your epinephrine auto-injector immediately.

WHAT TO DO IN CASE OF AN ANAPHYLACTIC REACTION?

1. **IMMEDIATELY ADMINISTER EPINEPHRINE using an auto-injector**
2. **CALL 9-1-1**
3. **ADMINISTER 2nd dose** if after 5 minutes symptoms continue or worsen
4. GO TO THE EMERGENCY ROOM. Medical monitoring is required for at least 4 hours
5. NOTIFY A CLOSE CONTACT (parent, guardian, etc.)



WHERE TO KEEP YOUR AUTO-INJECTOR?

- Always keep it with you (backpack, pocket, bag).
- Do not leave it in a car (extreme temperatures can reduce its effectiveness).
- Make sure people around you know where to find it.
- Check the expiration date of your auto-injector and replace it when needed.

HOW TO PREVENT AN ALLERGIC REACTION?

- Wear a medical alert bracelet indicating your allergies.
- Avoid any contact with your known allergens.
- Inform those around you (family, friends, teachers) on how to use epinephrine.

*The recommendations provided in this document are based on general knowledge and experience in the field. However, the educational material contained in this document is NOT a substitute for the clinical judgment necessary to address the diverse needs of patients.